Diego Javier Piña Lopez, LMSW, MPA

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Nonprofit executive, program designer, and Licensed Master Social Worker with more than a decade of experience turning complex initiatives into workable plans, coordinating teams and partners, and developing systems that support effective delivery. Led a $12 million multi-site humanitarian response involving 62 staff and more than 800 volunteers. Experienced in setting priorities as needs change, supporting teams through growth, collaborating with boards, and using operational data, research, and practical technology to improve decisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Therapist (LMSW) — Amanah Bloom Counseling | Tucson, AZ | Jul 2026–Present

- Provide strengths-based, client-centered counseling.
- Work collaboratively with clients from diverse backgrounds and life stages, emphasizing dignity, individual strengths, and their own goals for change.
- Develop group therapy activities that incorporate games and support therapeutic goal setting.

Researcher & Content Expert — Cherokee Federal | Remote | Apr 23 – Aug 25

- Prepared daily operational reports for public-sector partners on shelter capacity, service needs, and emerging risks, helping leaders make timely decisions across locations.
- Assessed health and social-service capacity for displaced Afghan populations across the United States through community meetings and assessments of employment barriers.
- Developed dashboards to compare resettlement resources and inform regional planning.
- Advised shelter partners on referral processes, service coordination, and longer-term settlement pathways.
- Managed a 10-person Arizona case-management team, setting priorities and coordinating employer relationships, refugee placements, and follow-up services.

Executive Director — Catholic Community Services of Southern Arizona | Tucson, AZ | Aug 19 – May 24

- Advanced from volunteer service in 2014 through program and director-level positions to Executive Director in 2023, gaining experience in both frontline operations and organizational leadership.
- Directed a $12 million multi-site shelter and reception system serving up to 1,800 asylum seekers nightly during periods of significant growth and operational change.
- Led 62 staff members and more than 800 volunteers across several sites, coordinating staffing, logistics, safety, and service delivery.
- Worked across shelter teams, public agencies, and faith communities to set priorities, activate emergency capacity, and support more than 8,000 people during a single week.
- Worked with organizational colleagues and partners to secure more than $13 million in public grants and philanthropic support for program operations and development.
- Built real-time operational and demographic reporting systems that helped teams decide where to allocate staff, capacity, and resources and supported donor accountability.
- Served as a public spokesperson, communicating program needs, the effects of government policies, and service outcomes while advocating for people seeking asylum.

Consultant — Catholic Charities USA | Remote | Sep 22 – Jun 24

- Designed and coordinated national referral workflows and information systems connecting border-service agencies with case-management partners in interior U.S. cities.
- Coordinated geographically dispersed agencies to agree on shared workflows, clarify responsibilities, and address practical implementation challenges.
- Developed program indicators and reporting tools to track case-management service interactions and outcomes.
- Conducted individual and group meetings with participating agencies to identify data-system challenges and additional support needs.

Senior Border Specialist — Save the Children | Jul 21 – Oct 22

- Coordinated U.S. border-response programs and partnerships with humanitarian organizations.
- Contributed to program planning, implementation, and resource and funding allocation within a $7M humanitarian response portfolio.
- Organized monthly interagency partner meetings with government, NGOs, and international NGOs.

BOARD LEADERSHIP & GOVERNANCE

Center for Victims of Torture — Board Member (2023 – Present)

- Served on the Policy and Advisory Committee and participated in the organization's CEO search committee.

Kaleidoscope Humanitarian Aid — Founding Board Member & Secretary (2025 – Present)

- Helped establish the organization's governance framework, bylaws, and board procedures.

RECOGNITION & AWARDS

- Invitee, White House Hispanic Heritage Month Celebration, 2023.
- Community Partner Award — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2022.
- Community Service Award — Southern Arizona Legal Aid, 2020.
- Emerging Leader of the Year — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2019.
- Emerging Social Worker of the Year — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2019.
- Kindness Award — Ben’s Bells Project, 2019.

EDUCATION

Master of Social Work (MSW) — Arizona State University, 2019

Master of Public Administration (MPA) — Arizona State University, 2018

Bachelor of Arts — Theater Education, University of Arizona, 2013

Bachelor of Arts — Religious Studies, University of Arizona, 2013

LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

- Arizona Community Foundation — CEO Survival Course (for NGOs) (2026)
- Board Leadership Training Program — Completed 2026

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Arizona Licensed Master Social Worker (LMSW) | UNICEF Psychological First Aid — Train-the-Trainer (2021)

MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

CNN — Fredricka Whitfield | Reuters — Ted Hesson & Liliana Salgado | NPR — Joel Rose | NPR — Ximena Bustillo | New York Times — Jack Healy